

Shared Tables

Street food, public markets, and city life in contemporary China

Elena Park

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About this book

Shared Tables explores how street food and public markets shape everyday city life in contemporary China. It follows vendors and residents through morning markets, neighborhood food streets, and shared dining spaces, showing how food connects daily routines with a sense of place.

The book considers markets as neighborhood gathering places and as part of local urban economies. Its case studies examine migration, changing food habits, small family businesses, and efforts to preserve market traditions during urban development.

The analysis draws on interviews with vendors and residents, observation in public markets, photographs, and historical sources. It emphasizes the variety of local experiences rather than treating city life as a single uniform pattern.

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Includes bibliographical references and index.